

Keru Chen

PhD Student in Electrical Engineering | Arizona State University

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Reinforcement learning, LLM post-training, and AI agents, including multi-agent systems. My interests center on safety, alignment, and decision-making under constraints, with applications to healthcare.

EDUCATION

Arizona State University

Aug 2025 - Present

PhD in Electrical Engineering

GPA: 3.89 / 4.00

Advisor: Prof. Shaofeng Zou

I also work closely with Prof. Sen Lin and Prof. Yingbin Liang.

Xi'an Jiaotong University

2021 - 2025

BEng in Automation

GPA: 3.5 / 4.3

PUBLICATIONS

Information-Directed Offline-to-Online Reinforcement Learning

Keru Chen

NeurIPS 2026, Main Conference. Also at ICML 2026 DEMO Workshop.

HIPO: Instruction Hierarchy via Constrained Reinforcement Learning

Keru Chen, Jun Luo, Sen Lin, Yingbin Liang, Alvaro Velasquez, Nathaniel Bastian, Shaofeng Zou

EMNLP 2026, Main Conference.

Towards Fast Safe Online Reinforcement Learning via Policy Finetuning

Keru Chen, Honghao Wei, Zhigang Deng, Sen Lin

Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2026.

Fourier Ptychographic Microscopy 10 Years On: A Review

F. Xu, Z. Wu, C. Tan, Y. Liao, Z. Wang, Keru Chen, An Pan

Cells, 13(4), 324, 2024.

PREPRINT

MeshHeal: Two-Timescale Self-Healing for Gray Failures in Decentralized LLM Agent Networks

Keru Chen, Sen Lin, Yingbin Liang, Nathaniel D. Bastian, Shaofeng Zou

arXiv:2609.29015, 2026.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Arizona State University

Aug 2025 - Present

Doctoral Research | Prof. Shaofeng Zou

- Study safe and constrained reinforcement learning, instruction hierarchy in language models, and reliability in multi-agent systems.
- Westlake University

Summer 2024

Research Intern | Prof. Donglin Wang

- Worked on reinforcement learning for robotic manipulation and RL-based fine-tuning of vision-language-action models.
- University of Houston

Sep 2023 - Jul 2025

Research Intern | Prof. Sen Lin

- Studied safe offline-to-online reinforcement learning and constrained policy fine-tuning; first-author paper accepted to TMLR in 2026.
- University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Jan 2024 - May 2024

Research Intern | Prof. Tianlong Chen

- Worked on time-series forecasting and security analysis of LLM and retrieval-augmented generation systems.
 - Contributed to research published at EMNLP 2024.
- Chinese Academy of Sciences

Feb 2023 - Oct 2023

Research Intern | Prof. An Pan | Xi'an, China

- Worked on computational imaging and Fourier ptychographic microscopy; co-authored a review published in Cells.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- Biomedical Image Translation with GANs

2024

Research Project

- Developed a multi-scale GAN for breast cancer cell image translation.
 - National Second Prize, National Biomedical Engineering Innovation Design Competition.
- Waveformer: EEG Sleep Stage Classification

2023

Research Project

- Built a transformer-based model combining wavelet transforms and deep learning for EEG sleep stage classification; code available on GitHub.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Conference Reviewer: NeurIPS 2026; ICLR 2027.
- Journal Reviewer: Scientific Reports; IEEE/ACM Transactions on Networking.

SKILLS

- Programming: Python (PyTorch), C/C++, MATLAB.
- Tools: Git/GitHub, Linux, LaTeX.
- Languages: Mandarin (native); English (IELTS 6.5).